Lesson plan · for the teacher

Safer school WhatsApp groups

Cyber safety · Level 1 · Lesson 4

Time
40 min

Materials
Board and chalk (or a large sheet of paper); Large paper for the rules poster, and pens or chalk; Six example posts on slips of paper; Worksheet: Safe group check (one per pair, optional)

Learning goals

- Explain why photos, marks and phone numbers should never be posted in big groups.
- Design five clear rules for a class group and explain each one.
- Describe how to check an urgent request and report a strange message.

Activity: Our class group rules: Rule makers

1. Warm-up (5 min): Ask who is in, or knows of, a family, football or faith group chat. Ask: what is the group for, and who decides what gets posted?
2. Teach (8 min): Read out the six example posts. For each, pupils vote: fine for a big group, share privately, or never share. Explain that photos, marks and numbers can be forwarded to anyone.
3. Rule makers (14 min): Groups of four write five rules for a class group: what it's for, who posts, what is never shared, how we treat each other, and what to do with a strange or urgent message.
4. Share (7 min): Each group reads its best rule. Build one class poster from the most popular rules, making sure it includes "check urgent requests with an adult" and "report and block strangers".
5. Wrap-up (6 min): Exit ticket: each pupil writes one thing they will never post in a group and what they would do with a strange message. Everyone signs the poster.

Draw a large phone on the board with an empty group chat. Write six example posts on slips of paper: a class photo, a mark list, a homework reminder, a phone number, an "urgent money" message and a match result.

Discussion

- What happens in a group with no rules?
- Could a new pupil understand each rule in one reading?
- Which rule protects us most?

Exit ticket

- One thing I'll never post + what I do with a strange message.

Try it in class tomorrow
Write class group rules together: Draw a phone on the board with an empty group chat. Ask: what is this group for, who may post, what must never be shared, and what do we do with a strange message? Write five rules together and let everyone sign.

Worksheet · for pupils

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Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

1 **You're the admin of a 200-parent notice group. Which settings help?**

- [ ] Only admins can send messages
- [ ] Only admins can edit group info
- [ ] Admins approve new members
- [ ] Share the invite link on public pages
- [ ] Turn off all notifications

2 **A school WhatsApp group is private, so pupils' marks can be posted there.**

- ◯ True
- ◯ False

3 **Match each setting to the problem it solves.**

Only admins send messages	• • • •	A stolen text code
Approve new members	• • • •	Being added to scam groups
Groups privacy: my contacts	• • • •	Strangers joining by link
Two-step verification	• • • •	Notices lost in hundreds of replies

4 **Which of these is safe to post in a 300-member parents' group?**

- ◯ A pupil's report card
- ◯ A class list with phone numbers
- ◯ Sports day moved to Thursday
- ◯ Pupils at the school gate

5 **Which privacy setting stops strangers adding you to groups?**

- ◯ Groups: Everyone
- ◯ Groups: My contacts
- ◯ Last seen: Nobody
- ◯ Read receipts: Off

✎ **Think of one school group you're in. Which setting or rule would you change first, and who would you ask to help?**